



PRANAB MUKHERJEE

Minister of Finance

Mr Quick Fix

Although his dream of moving to the Race Course Road is yet to come true, he is the de facto head of this Government. Whether it is placating the allies or wooing new numbers to defeat a crucial Cut Motion against the Government, he is the UPA's chief troubleshooter. So indispensable is Mukherjee that the prime minister once postponed an important Cabinet meet because Pranab's meeting with a visiting Sheikh Hasina got delayed.

Achievements

- Ensured a GDP growth of 7.2 per cent at a time of collapsing world economies.
- Increased the social sector budget allocation to over one-third of the Union Budget, in keeping with UPA II's agenda.
- Has set the tone to rein in fiscal deficit from the current 6.9 per cent to 5.5 per cent.

Biggest Regret

The veteran Congress leader from West Bengal once reportedly joked that lack of fluency in Hindi was one of the main obstacles on the path of becoming the prime minister.

Failures

- Despite assurances by his ministry, inflation is still not under control.
- Has struggled to get the derailed goods and services tax proposal back on track.
- Has not been decisive enough on setting a target for disinvestment, necessary to resolve the resource crunch.

▼ 63%

Delivery
Meter

FLOP	MEDIOCRE	GOOD
0-33%	34-64%	65-100%

SHARAD PAWAR

Minister of Agriculture & Consumer Affairs
Food and Public Distribution

Bounced Out

The Baron of Baramati has been a crutch of the UPA during its twin avatars. With his knack for handling the sharper turns of politics and administration, many expected him to come out with a pitch-perfect solution to spiralling food prices. But in his quest to keep farmers happy, he has annoyed the consumers.

Achievements

- Achieved record wheat and rice production despite severe drought conditions.
- Facilitated credit for farmers and encouraged farm loan repayments by giving 2 per cent interest rebate.

Failures

- In inflation control and food-grain management. Food price inflation touched an 11-year high in 2009 at 19.75 per cent.
- To strengthen the public distribution system; poor coordination with states for foodgrain distribution.

Biggest Mistake

Making the infamous statement: "I am not an astrologer to tell when prices will fall."

▼ 41%

